of their customers, shareholders and debenture holders.

Loose Leaf Indexing is flexible and adaptable to different users. It offers ample scope for expansion with the main drawback of loss or damages.

Merits of Page or Book Index:

1. It is very cheap and simple method.
2. It requires less space.
3. It can be carried from one place to another.

Demerits of Page or Book Index:

1. A strict alphabetical arrangement of names on each page may not be possible.
2. Names must be deleted once they are no longer of any use. This may present a shabby appearance.
3. It is an inflexible system of indexing, scope for further entries even in case of loose leaf index is limited.

iii. Vowel Indexing: In case where the number of correspondents is very large the alphabetical indexing is further classified. The names of the correspondents are entered on one page or the other according to the letter with which his name begins and first vowel in his name. This sort of indexing is known as "Vowel Indexing". E.g. AShika the first vowel in the name is "I". It will be classified under "Ai"

(b) Card Index: Under this method references are entered on the cards of uniform size. These cards bear the names, number of the files and other particulars to be indexed. Cards are arranged in either alphabetical or numerical order and are place in drawers or boxes which may have a rod running from one ending to the other end for holding cards in their places. These drawers are divided into alphabetical sections by means of guide cards.



Fig. 5.11. Card Index

The purposes for which card index may be used are listed below.

a) As catalogue of books in library;

b) To contain specimen signatures of customers in bank.

c) To contain addresses and other particulars of customers;

d) To maintain accounts of store items;

e) To maintain history of employees;

f) To keep records of installment sales.

Merits of Card Indexing System:

1. The cards provide a complete list of

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